finally proclaimed it will be necessary to keep revisiting the history of conflict as efforts to put society back together continue. There is no easy answer after so many years of strife and trauma. To help reconcile this history with Myanmar's current situation, the book is divided into three parts in addition to this introduction and the conclusion: 'war and order', 'elections and after', and 'us and them'.

The book's examination of war in contemporary Myanmar begins, in Chapter 2, with Su Mon Thazin Aung's discussion of the peace process that unfolded under Thein Sein. Her chapter offers a crucial foundation for assessment of conflict in Myanmar during this fragile stage of political transition. Next, in Chapter 3, Costas Laoutides and Anthony Ware re-examine the relevance of ethnic identity to the Kachin conflict, drawing on research undertaken since the resumption of hostilities in 2011. Given the level of violence suffered in Kachin areas in recent years, it is important that Jenny Hedström, in Chapter 4, explores the gendered aspects of insecurity in Kachin State. Taken together these Kachin-focused chapters offer a strong overview of the unresolved wars that have made life so difficult in Myanmar's borderlands. Ricky Yue then looks, in Chapter 5, at the Pa-O Self-Administered Zone in southern Shan State. This is an important case study for thinking about how marginal areas have been incorporated into the Myanmar nation-building project. It is followed, in Chapter 6, by Gregory S. Cathcart's discussion of landmines as a form of community protection in eastern Myanmar.

In the next part, writers turn their attention to the political process and the elections. This section begins with Chapter 7, which is by Michael Lidauer. It explains the results of the 2015 general election in terms of evolving conflict dynamics. This is followed by Chaw Chaw Sein's Chapter 8, on the role of various institutions in Myanmar's 2015 election. She looks particularly closely at the election commission, international agencies, and the military. Next is an essay by Than Tun on the challenging context of religion and ethnicity in Rakhine State. He considers the role of Buddhist nationalism in the 2015 election result. Chapter 10 by Chit Win then explores the changing role of the legislature in managing conflict during Myanmar's fragile transition from direct military rule. It offers lessons on the unexpected potential of the Union Assembly to deal with some of the country's most difficult issues. This chapter is followed by Melissa Crouch's interrogation of legislative practice during the reform period, with a specific focus on the various ways that conflict has been managed.